

Investment Memo - Cartograph AI

Date: January 2026
Sector: Data & Analytics
Stage: Series A (\$10M round)
Author: Investment team
Recommendation: PASS

Company overview

Cartograph AI builds a geospatial analytics platform for retail and real-estate teams. It blends foot-traffic data, demographics, and satellite imagery to score locations and predict store performance before a lease is signed.

Founders

Marcus Webb - CEO. Former real-estate analytics lead at a national retail chain.
Priya Anand - CTO. PhD in remote sensing; built satellite-imagery pipelines.

Problem and solution

Picking retail locations is still done with spreadsheets and gut feel. Cartograph turns it into a data problem: a single score per site, plus a forecast of monthly revenue, updated as new mobility data arrives.

Traction

- \$600k ARR, growing ~8% month over month.
- 14 customers, mostly regional retail chains on annual contracts.
- Net revenue retention 103%; logo churn around 9% annually.

Business model

Annual SaaS subscription priced per analyzed market, with an enterprise tier for chains running many simultaneous site searches.

Market

Location intelligence is a real and growing market, but crowded - several large incumbents and data brokers already sell similar feeds.

Strengths

- Strong technical founder with genuine remote-sensing depth.
- Clear, quantifiable ROI when a single bad lease costs millions.
- Differentiated satellite-imagery pipeline.

Risks and concerns

- Growth is slow for the stage (8% MoM) and ARR is small (\$600k).
- Crowded market with well-funded incumbents and commoditized data feeds.
- Data licensing costs compress margins and create dependency on third parties.
- Sales cycles into conservative real-estate buyers are long.

Decision

PASS. The team is strong and the product is real, but at Series A we need to see faster growth and a clearer moat than a data-aggregation play in a crowded market.

Revisit if growth accelerates past 15% MoM or they lock in proprietary data rights.